

WORKING DRAFT

ClassE US language guide

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PURPOSE

The purpose of this guide is to project our mindsets and shared beliefs about education, and to make sure we use updated language that doesn't distract from our ability to deliver.

STATUS

Current working draft as of September 29, 2026. This will keep changing. Review anything in it before using it.

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Why this matters

US buyers hear a partner who shares their beliefs about students and teachers, and they trust ClassE with their students.

We know that US buyers are skeptical of edtech. Many have been burned before, so they look for signals, good or bad.

Results come first. But buyers also need to know we think the way they do. They answer to their community for every choice they make with public money, and a vendor they choose becomes part of that choice.

A district that buys ClassE is saying, “This is the best place to spend public funds for our kids.” So we have to be above reproach.

What matters most is not the words. It is the mindsets behind them. Most of the “Instead of” examples in this guide come from our own calls, including some of Christopher’s. They work in Israel. A US buyer hears them differently, so we keep the idea and change the words. Where the guide suggests wording, it is one option, and we may choose a different one.

SHARED BELIEFS

This language is based on core beliefs that are widely shared in US schools.

Every child can, and will, grow.

Every child can make radical growth in the right conditions. Our job is to help build those conditions.

Kids do well if they can.

This is an idea from Ross Greene, a US psychologist. A student who is struggling is missing a skill, not the will. When a student has a learning gap, it means we have not found the right way yet. Never, ever because the kid does not want to.

We never blame students or families.

Nothing we say can be heard as blaming kids or not believing in them. We never blame parents. Families are our partners.

Every student is an individual.

We see each student as an individual. We never generalize about a child from a group or from one story. A student’s culture, language and community are strengths the student brings.

Language to get right

Organized by the topics where language most often goes wrong. Most examples come from real calls.

	✗ INSTEAD OF	✓ TRY	WHAT WENT WRONG
Race, language and other lines of difference Every student and family is an individual. Never generalize from a group, and use the district's own words for its students.	"These parents are working two jobs. They just don't have time."	"What does support at home look like in your community?"	It guesses about families as a group.
	"It's very helpful to engage these kids."	"Let's look at what each student did."	"These kids" turns individual students into a group.
	"Your ESL students," "LEP"	"Your English learners," or the district's own term, such as "emergent bilingual" in Texas.	ESL is a program, not a name for a child. Federal law replaced LEP with "English learner."
	A joke about your own accent as proof of ClassE's Spanish support	Answer the question plainly, in the district's words.	It ties a language to a group of people, and it is not evidence.
	"An equity engine that dismantles traditional testing and builds belonging." Equity, DEI or "culturally responsive" used for ClassE.	Follow the buyer's lead on equity language, and say what ClassE does for each student.	It takes a political side the buyer did not ask about. In Texas, state law limits DEI work in schools.
	"I don't see color."	Do not raise race.	Today it can sound like not seeing the student.
	✗ INSTEAD OF	✓ TRY	WHAT WENT WRONG
Disability and special services Name the student first. A student's disability, plan and services are private, and they are decided by the school team.	"We can help ADHD students." "Cognitive issues." "Students with different diagnosed learning disabilities."	"A student with a disability," or what the student needs.	Most US educators name the student first, and a student's disability category is private. If a family uses its own word, use theirs.
	"Special needs kids," "SPED student"	"A student with a disability."	Both sound out of date in a US school.
	"Special accommodations for special needs kids."	For ClassE features: "accessibility supports."	Accessibility is not special education. Accommodations are decided by the student's IEP or 504 team.
	"Accommodate" and "modify," used as if they mean the same thing	"Accommodation" when the student reaches the same work another way. "Modification" when the work itself changes.	They are different decisions, made by the student's IEP or 504 team.
	"A neurodivergent student," as the general term	What the student needs.	It is a word some people use about themselves. Follow the family's lead.

	✗ INSTEAD OF	✓ TRY	WHAT WENT WRONG
Academic results Describe what a student did, not what the student is. Claim only what has been measured.	“Closing the gaps with the weakest students.” “Weak students,” “strong students,” “a GAP student.”	“Seven students missed this skill. The teacher can teach them in a small group.”	It ranks children by level.
	“She’s a pretty good student.”	“This student got these questions right on this skill.”	Praise is still a judgment about the child.
	“He’s got competency issues across the board.” “Needs help,” “competent,” about a student.	“This student missed these three questions.”	It labels the child. Describe the answers.
	“At risk,” “low performing,” about a student	“Students who have not shown this skill yet.”	In Texas, at risk is a legal category. Low performing is a federal term for schools.
	“80% of the class got that question right, so 80% has achieved mastery in that standard.” “Mastered,” “proficient,” “masters of this skill.”	“80% of the class got that question right.” Over several weeks: “progress toward mastery.”	Mastery is a conclusion, and proficient and masters are state test labels. One question cannot carry them.
	“Thousands of kids that use ClassE in Israel have better grades.”	“Schools in Israel use it. We don’t have a controlled study of its effect on grades yet.”	It claims a result nobody has measured, and a US buyer will ask how we know.
	“She had a 44, then she was remediated, went up to a 60.”	“That’s one student’s result. It’s not proof yet.”	One story is not evidence.
	“Proven,” “evidence-based,” “ESSA certified”	“We don’t have a controlled study on that yet. Here’s what we can show you.”	ESSA tiers rate the evidence behind a program. The federal government does not certify products.
	How many students or schools use ClassE, offered as a result	“Here is what students got right and wrong, on which skills.”	Usage is not a result.
	“We bring the students to the test.” “We design our questions around the exact model of what they’re going to see on that test.”	“We help the student up to the question.” “We build the practice on your curriculum and your standards.”	It sounds like teaching to the test.
	“Marks”	“Scores,” “grades.”	It is British usage.

	✗ INSTEAD OF	✓ TRY	WHAT WENT WRONG
Data Say what the data shows, not what it concludes.	“We can do 10 exercises and diagnose exactly what the problem is.”	“The student got these questions wrong on this skill. This is where to focus next.”	“Diagnose” sounds like a disability evaluation, which only the district runs, with the parent’s consent.
	“Diagnostic,” “assessment platform,” “diagnostic and remediation tool,” as the name for ClassE	Describe what ClassE does. “Diagnostic” is fine later, about skills and standards.	The first label decides what the buyer compares ClassE to. Buyers who heard “diagnostic” first said, “Oh, so you’re i-Ready.”
	“We analyze each answer and identify exactly where the student’s reasoning is breaking down.”	“Here are the questions the student got wrong on this skill.”	It claims to see inside the student’s head.
	“Data-driven”	“Data-informed.”	It sounds like the numbers make the decisions.
	“Progress monitoring,” for ClassE	Describe the evidence in plain words.	Progress monitoring is the district’s process, with its own requirements. See US terms.
	✗ INSTEAD OF	✓ TRY	WHAT WENT WRONG
Student support Extra help runs through the district’s system. Use its words for its programs, and describe ClassE by what students do in it.	“Intervention,” “intervention platform,” for ClassE	Say what each part does: the teacher gets what they need to intervene, and Albert gives each student targeted support.	On its own, “intervention” tells a US buyer ClassE is a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program, and they will ask for that evidence.
	“We are doing exercises plus a Tier 1 type of remediation.” “Your Tier 3 kids.”	“Your team decides which support each student gets. ClassE gives your team data.”	Tiers are the district’s system, never a name for ClassE or a student.
	“We are a remediation tool.”	“Targeted practice,” “targeted support.” Use “remediation” if the district says it first.	It is the district’s word to choose.
	“Acceleration,” for ClassE	“Targeted practice.”	In Texas, acceleration is a program set in law, with minimum hours and tutor ratios.
	“Exercises,” “an exercise platform”	“Practice,” “practice questions.”	“An exercise platform” can sound like a fitness app to a US ear.
	“The movement from tier to tier,” for scores	“Score band,” “performance level.”	A Texas listener hears an MTSS tier.

Check locally

There are regional and district-level differences. A few things to check before a call:

- How does the district or state refer to students learning English?
- How does it refer to students with disabilities, and to its tiers of extra help?
- What does it call its standards and its state test?
- What are its policies on student use of AI? That decides how much Albert becomes a selling point.

Texas and New York, side by side

The same word can be safe in one state and risky in the other. The laws and policies here were checked in September 2026.

	Texas	New York and the Northeast
Law and policy	SB 12, a Texas law limiting DEI work in K-12 schools, in effect since September 1, 2025. A federal court has blocked parts of it in some districts while the case continues.	The Culturally Responsive-Sustaining Education Framework, New York State guidance since 2019.
Equity words	Do not raise equity, DEI or identity words. If the district uses one, follow its lead.	Many schools use equity, identity and asset framing words. Follow the buyer’s lead. Using a buyer’s own words is not the same as raising DEI.
How to open	“ClassE gives students practice on your curriculum and your standards, once we set it up with you.” Say “TEKS” only after the team confirms the alignment.	The same sentence.
State test	STAAR. A 2025 law, HB 8, replaces it with new tests starting in 2027-28. Use the name the district uses. Its top level is “Masters Grade Level,” so Texas educators say “masters” as an official label. Never use “mastery” for a ClassE result.	The New York State tests.
English learners	“Emergent bilingual” for the student. “ESL” or “bilingual” for the program.	“English Language Learners (ELLs),” the New York State term. New York also uses “Multilingual Learners (MLs)” for a wider group.

Open questions

- **“Diagnostic” and “intervention.”** The guide suggests not calling ClassE “diagnostic” or “an intervention.” To a US buyer, “diagnostic” can sound like a disability evaluation, and “intervention” like a formal Tier 2 or Tier 3 program. Is everyone comfortable moving away from both as names for ClassE?
- **“Mastery” in the product.** Teachers still see “mastery” in ClassE, including off a single question. The recommendation is to change it to “progress toward mastery,” the language in this guide. Can the product make that change?

US terms and sources

IEP (Individualized Education Program)	A legal plan for a student who qualifies for special education under IDEA. A team that includes the parents sets the student's goals, services, accommodations and any modifications, and reviews the plan at least once a year. It is a confidential student record.
504 plan	A plan under Section 504 of the Rehabilitation Act for a student with a disability who needs accommodations, such as extra time, to access regular classes. It usually does not change what the student is expected to learn.
IDEA (Individuals with Disabilities Education Act)	The federal special education law. It defines 13 disability categories and guarantees eligible students a free appropriate public education.
MTSS (Multi-Tiered System of Supports)	The framework many US districts use to organize extra help. Tier 1 is core instruction for every student. Tier 2 adds targeted, usually small-group support for some students. Tier 3 is intensive, often individual support for a few. The district uses its own data to decide which students get which tier.
RTI (Response to Intervention)	An earlier, academics-focused version of the same tiered approach. Many districts have folded it into MTSS, and some still use the name. Some states also use it when deciding whether a student has a learning disability.
Progress monitoring	Short, frequent checks the district uses to see whether a student in Tier 2 or Tier 3, or working on an IEP goal, is responding to support. The tools use alternate forms of equal difficulty so results can be compared over time.
ESSA (Every Student Succeeds Act)	The main federal K-12 law, passed in 2015. It sets four tiers of evidence that districts use to judge programs: strong, moderate, promising, and demonstrates a rationale.
Accommodation and modification	An accommodation changes how a student reaches the work, such as extra time or text read aloud. A modification changes the work itself. The student's IEP or 504 team decides both.
English learner, emergent bilingual, ELL, ML	Terms for students learning English. Texas law uses "emergent bilingual." New York uses "English Language Learners" and, for a wider group, "Multilingual Learners."
ENL (English as a New Language)	The New York name for its English language program.
STAAR	The Texas state test. HB 8 replaces it with new tests starting in 2027-28.
TEKS (Texas Essential Knowledge and Skills)	The Texas state standards: what students are expected to know and do in each grade and subject.
WCAG (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines)	The standard for accessible websites and software. Districts may require it when they buy software.

Sources, with laws and legal terms checked in September 2026: at risk, Texas Education Code 29.081. Emergent bilingual, Texas Education Code 29.052. Acceleration, Texas HB 4545 and HB 1416. LEP, replaced by "English learner" in ESSA (2015). SB 12, in effect September 1, 2025, with parts blocked by a federal court in some districts while the case continues. STAAR, replaced by new tests starting in 2027-28 under Texas HB 8 (2025). New York student data, Education Law 2-d requires a data privacy agreement when a vendor receives student data. Neurodivergent, not one of the 13 IDEA disability categories. Kids do well if they can, Ross Greene.

In an effort to be transparent, AI was used to create this document in the following ways: initial research, rewording, layout, formatting, and thought partnering.